Fifth, and most importantly, India's external emphasis on the narrative of pluralism will only hold as long as it is able to sustain pluralism at home. India's soft power efficacy abroad will hinge on its ability to lead by example, especially on delivering sustainable development, economic modernisation, and good governance through an open, inclusive, and democratic system. To effectively balance China or reassure its smaller neighbours, India will have to keep investing in the peacefulness of its religious diversity, the social order and developmental wellbeing of its citizens, the independence and health of its democratic institutions, and the economic innovation driven by its private entrepreneurs.

Notes

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